

he made nearly \$30,000 in commissions. Consequently, Bob and Sue felt they could commit to buying a home, which they did. Sue's parents loaned them the down payment. With closing

costs, attorney fees, and so on, they owed another \$1,500, which they charged on credit.

Next came the usual household expenses for drapes, furniture, lawn mower, and appliances. Even so, they might have been able to squeeze by if everything went just right—which it didn't.

Their five-year-old car broke down, as it did regularly, so Bob bought a new car by selling his old car, borrowing some money from his parents, and taking out a \$6,000, 18-percent car loan. Although neither Bob nor Sue realized it at the time, they had stepped into one of Satan's modern traps, just as surely as Eve had in the garden. Satan asked Eve, "Indeed has God said, 'You shall not eat from any tree of the garden?'" (Genesis 3:1b) Today he asks, "Surely you can trust God for the good things you need, can't you?" And using about the same wisdom as Adam and Eve, Bob and Sue borrowed to buy things they couldn't afford to own. Satan then had them hooked, and all he needed to do was wait until the line played out.

Bob and Sue's line played out when Sue unexpectedly got pregnant about six months after moving into their new home. Frequent bouts of morning sickness caused her to take a leave of absence from her job. Then the downhill financial slide started. Without Sue's income, the house and car payments alone took 70 percent of their pay. After food, gas, utilities, and the other monthly essentials, no money was left for clothes, entertainment, lunches, and least of all, medical expenses.

Every trip to the doctor meant prescription bills and non-reimbursed expenses, and every trip resulted in an argument over money or, more accurately, the lack of it. What should have been a joyful event was soon to be a disaster.

About three months into the pregnancy, the economy soured for stock investing and Bob lost his job. He was out of work for nearly two months, during which time virtually all